farmer to load and offload the capsicums along with market access where his produce was eventually sold. The next day, the empowered group filed the aforementioned actions in the action-taken report which was then included in the prime minister's media report the subsequent day.

Another example was of news reports arising from Noida that despite assurances from the chief minister, doorstep delivery of essentials was not being permitted. Once again, the same empowered group was alerted who then reached out to the district collector. The collector confirmed facts on the ground and immediately reported back to the empowered group that the issue was arising not because the vendors were not willing to deliver but because some residential colonies were not permitting access to delivery boys beyond the main gate.[39] The happenings of this episode were filed in the prime minister's media report for his review, as per protocol.

Another problem which came up was that although there were no curbs on transportation of essential products, the truck drivers and the trucks themselves didn't have the required e-passes and there was confusion about how they could access them. Several times, these vehicles would be detained at state borders since interstate transport was also not allowed (barring essential commodities). Due to this, the plying of commercial vehicles carrying essentials had drastically reduced which was an indication that if no action was taken quickly, the supply of essentials and medicines would soon be impacted. Normally, pre-lockdown about 18–24 lakh commercial vehicles would use the Indian roads every day in which 0.8 lakh metric tonnes of food grains would be transported in rakes by the Food Corporation of India (FCI). In the first few days of the lockdown, that number had drastically reduced to merely three to four lakh trucks on an average plying on the roads. Once again the empowered group had to step in and ensure that no local authorities would stop the plying of trucks and other commercial vehicles carrying essential items. They started to maintain a daily tracker to keep an eye on what percentage of the baseline number had the operation of commercial vehicles carrying essentials reached. They also kept a daily tracker of food arrival in major mandis and what percentage of baseline it was on each day of the lockdown. Markers such as traffic of trucks carrying specific items such as packaged food, pharmaceutical products and fertilizers, traffic of rakes and port traffic was also monitored on a daily basis by the empowered group. The efforts yielded results when later it was observed that by the first week of April,